

Year 4 Writing - Show, Don't Tell Emotions

Aussie Primary Academy

Name: _____

Date: _____

Curriculum Focus

ACARA v9.0: AC9E4LY06 - plan, create and edit written texts for imaginative, informative and persuasive purposes.

Learning Intention

I can show a character's feelings through actions, body language and thoughts.

Writing Strategy

Instead of naming the feeling, show what the character does. Readers can infer the emotion from clues.

Vocabulary Helper

infer - work out an idea using clues

body language - what a person's face or body shows

emotion - a feeling such as joy, worry or pride

Model Example

Tell: Ben was nervous.

Show: Ben rubbed his hands together and stared at the classroom door. His backpack suddenly felt too heavy.

The second version gives clues instead of naming the feeling.

Success Checklist

- ☐ I understand the purpose.
- ☐ I can choose strong words.
- ☐ I can organise my ideas.
- ☐ I can reread and improve my work.

Before You Write

Think before you write. Who is the audience? What is the purpose? Which words will help your reader understand your idea?

Mini Practice

Quick try: Show one feeling using an action or body clue.

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Page 2 - Practise, write and improve

Warm Up

Rewrite this sentence by showing the feeling: Ava was excited.

Ava: _____

Build Your Skills

Choose one emotion: worried, proud, surprised or disappointed. Write 3-4 sentences that show the emotion without naming it.

Strong Challenge

Swap with a partner. Can they guess the emotion from your clues? Add one more clue if needed.

I Can Checklist

- ☐ I can use actions to show feelings.
- ☐ I can use body language.
- ☐ I can add thoughts or sensory details.

★ High Five!

You made feelings come alive on the page. That is premium writer craft!

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____

Year 4 Writing - Show, Don't Tell - Answer Key

For teachers, parents and tutors

Teacher Notes

Look for observable actions, body language and internal thoughts. Students should not simply replace one feeling word with another.

Sample Response / Success Guide

Example: Zara held the certificate with both hands. A smile spread across her face, and she looked back at her teacher before standing a little taller.

Likely feeling: proud or happy.

What to Look For

Look for: clear purpose, organised ideas, topic vocabulary, full sentences, correct punctuation and at least one revision/improvement.

Parent Tip - At Home

At home, play “guess the feeling”. Act out a feeling without naming it, then write the clues you used.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Create a class emotion bank. For each emotion, students brainstorm face, hands, voice and movement clues before writing.

Mini Rubric and Next Step

Mini rubric:

- 4 - Clear purpose, organised ideas and careful editing.
- 3 - Good ideas with some detail and mostly correct punctuation.
- 2 - Ideas are beginning, but more detail or structure is needed.
- 1 - Needs support to plan, write and reread.

Next step choices: add detail, replace a weak word, check punctuation, or read the writing aloud.